

come across something that will clear the air a bit.” This even adds an interactive element, and can spark off a discussion right in the comments section of your blog.

Talking about authority in a little detail, there are two aspects to it: one is that you should write a post after having researched enough about it, or if you already know enough about the topic at hand. The other is the language aspect of it: you want your readers to feel they’re getting the best content out there, so choose your words with care.

At the same time, quote your sources, like we said before. No one likes pronouncements that aren’t backed up by facts: if it’s an original idea, make sure you go into sufficient detail to make it believable.

A corollary of being articulate is that you shouldn’t ramble. Let’s emphasise it: you *must not* ramble—your readers will not like it. Rambling is a mistake too many bloggers make, being carried away by the whole idea of the blog being a platform for all their thoughts. Give your readers a thought: this is 2007, and people are busy. They want good content—they have no time to wade through your ramblings. By “rambling,” we specifically mean going off topic too often and for too long. If the “off-topics” interest you sufficiently, write another blog post about those.

A suggestion here if a topic has too many sub-topics: write little posts on each of them, and link to all of them in your main post. But, to repeat, each individual post should be self-contained. (Remember what we said about focus.) A reader must never be left wondering what that was all about.

Of course, some people like to ramble, and use their blogs as their online diaries. Blogs with names such as “The Random Ramblings Of...” are all too common. If you feel the need to vent, to “get it out of your system,” use a separate, most private blog—which will, in all probability, not be a roaring success.